

The AI Automation Checklist

Twenty questions to find where your team is losing hours to work a machine should do.

How to use it: Go through each question about how your team actually works. Every box you check is a place custom software, an automation, or AI could give those hours back. Tally your checks at the end.

1. Data entry & handoffs

- ☐ Does anyone retype the same information into more than one system?
- ☐ Do you copy data from email into a CRM, spreadsheet, or database by hand?
- ☐ Does moving a lead, order, or customer to the next stage take manual steps?
- ☐ Do you export from one tool just to import it into another?

2. Documents

- ☐ Do you read PDFs, invoices, or forms and retype what's in them?
- ☐ Do you generate the same documents — quotes, contracts, reports — over and over?
- ☐ Do you rename, file, or sort documents by hand?

3. Communication & follow-up

- ☐ Do you send the same email or message repeatedly with small tweaks?
- ☐ Do leads or customers wait because a reply has to be written manually?
- ☐ Do you manually remind clients or teammates about deadlines and next steps?

4. Reporting & data

- ☐ Do you build the same report each week or month by pulling numbers by hand?
- ☐ Do you copy-paste between spreadsheets to see the whole picture?
- ☐ Are decisions delayed because the data lives in separate, disconnected tools?

5. Scheduling & coordination

- ☐ Do you go back and forth to book meetings, jobs, or appointments?
- ☐ Do you manually assign work or route requests to the right person?

6. Approvals & internal process

- ☐ Do requests sit in someone's inbox waiting for a yes or no?
- ☐ Does onboarding a customer or employee mean someone runs a manual checklist each time?

7. The gut check

- ☐ Is there a task your team quietly dreads because it's so repetitive?
- ☐ If one person is out sick, does a manual process grind to a halt?
- ☐ Have you ever thought, "there has to be a better way to do this"?

Your score

0–3 checks — You're lean. A few targeted automations could still free real time.

4–8 checks — You're losing hours every week. There's clear ROI in automating.

9+ checks — Manual work has become a tax on your whole team. This is exactly what we fix.

Circle your top three.

Those are where to start — the tasks eating the most time for the least reason. Want a hand? Tell us your #1 bottleneck at erasefriction.com and we'll come back within 48 hours with a real assessment. No pitch, no fluff.